

Linux Mint

It's becoming difficult these days to come across a discussion on any forum about a good Linux distribution for beginners and not encounter the name 'Mint'. Mint is a distribution heavily derived from Ubuntu, so much so that it is completely binary compatible with it and uses the exact same Ubuntu repositories for package downloads.

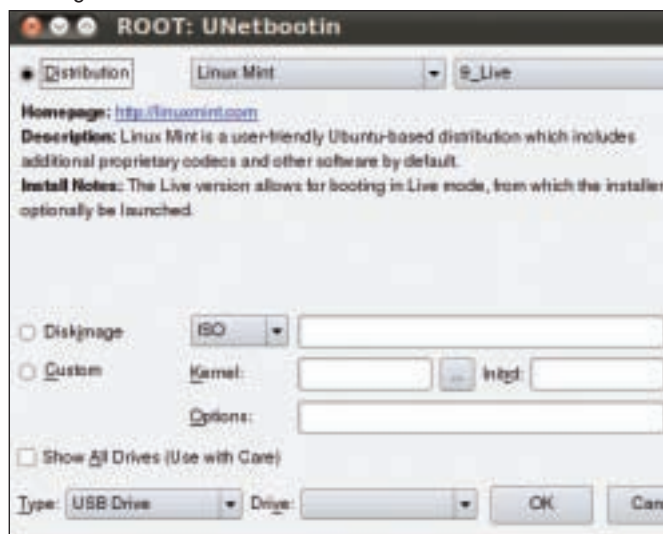
The major difference between Mint and Ubuntu is based on philosophy and converts to ease of use and functionality out-of-the-box for the end user. Primarily, Mint is Ubuntu packaged with restricted drivers and codecs. So as an end user, your MP3s and DVDs play out-of-



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An elegant distribution with a sense of humor



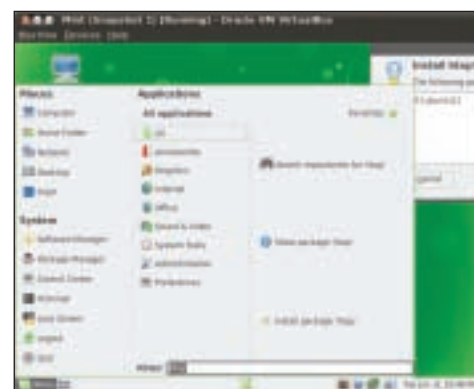
UNetbootin: Your go-to tool for Linux on a flash drive

select the drive, the USB drive menu and you are good to go. It will automatically download the distribution and create a bootable Live USB driver out of it. If you already have the image on your computer then you can just point to the path in the Diskimage radio option, instead of selecting the Distribution radio option and click OK. Short of bringing world peace, this should do the trick.

Installing a package

Mint started primarily as just Ubuntu with integrated media codecs. Since then, it has included many improvements for usability enhancement – one of the primary being the inclusion of new menu. The new menu lists your favourite appli-

the-box and your graphics card works much better too. These slight usability enhancements has already made Mint a top three distribution on distrowatch.com. Here are few tips to make your experience even better.



Custom Menu makes package installation a breeze

Install on a pen drive

If your computer doesn't have a working disk drive, or you're just too lazy to burn a buggy CD-ROM to install and try Mint, then fret not. Just go to unetbootin.sourceforge.net/ and download UnetBootIN, a universal and cross-platform tool for creating Live USB drives for various Linux distributions.

Once downloaded, just execute. The process is pretty simple. As you can see, just select 'Linux Mint' in the distribution menu and then select the version you want. In our case, we are going with 9_Live. Then, insert a pen drive of size 1 GB or more,

cations, commonly used applications, a Windows 7-like search bar, and common file locations in one go.

A hidden and less commonly used feature, though immensely useful feature of this menu, is its ability to search and install a software straightaway. Let us take the example of installing Htop, a brilliant command prompt clone of your system monitor. When you will type htop in the "filter" bar of the menu and if it isn't already installed on your system, mint will give you three further options, one of them will be install package 'htop'. This will initiate a 'I am feeling lucky' type search and will begin